
ALI ABOLGHASEMI

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🌐 ABOLGHASEMI.ME

🌐 Canadian-Iranian

EDUCATION

- **HEC Montréal** **2022**
PhD in Finance
- **Concordia University** **2015**
MA in Economics
- **University of Tehran** **2006**
BA in Economics

Appointment

JULY 2022

Assistant Professor of Finance at Saint Mary's University

WORKING PAPERS

2021

Granular Gravity: Equity-Bond Returns & Correlation, Job Market Paper

Investors care about the state of granularity, the heavy tail of firms' size distribution. I adapt and extend an existing granularity measure, and show that changes in granularity are negatively related to the cross-section of corporate bond returns. I verify that the risk-adjusted return on a strategy that provides effective hedge against granularity shocks is economically significant. I further document that the correlation between firms bond and equity returns is 50% higher when the economy becomes more granular than atomistic. Data supports the hypothesis that this arises from granularity being a priced factor in the cross-sections of both equity and corporate bond returns.

PRESENTED AT

HEC Montréal Finance Seminars (March 2021), HEC Montréal PhD Brownbags (March 2021), Global Finance Conference (May 2021), World Finance Conference (Aug. 2021), NOVA Finance PhD Countdown (Aug. 2021), Bank of Canada (Sep. 2021), Southern Finance Conference (Nov. 2021)

2020

Equity Prices in a Granular Economy, with Harjoat Bhamra, Christian Dorion & Alexandre Jean-neret

This paper revisits the properties of the conditional CAPM when the economy is granular. When some firms are more like "grains" than atoms, shocks to such firms are not diversified away. When a large firm becomes larger, the economy becomes more granular, as the large firm represents a greater share of the market. This increase in granularity translates into a higher cross-sectional difference in equity betas, which reduces the slope of the Security Market Line (SML). We provide empirical support for the negative relation between the slope of the SML and various granularity measures from the U.S. equity market. When granularity decreases, portfolio betas are strongly and positively related to average equity returns. In contrast, the relation turns negative when granularity increases, thereby explaining the relatively "flat" SML observed unconditionally.

PRESENTED AT

Northern Finance Association (Sep 2020), Université Laval (Feb 2020), HEC-McGill Winter Workshop (March 2020)

TEACHING

2021

Lecturer, *Futures and Options (B.Com.; Median Evaluation 4/4)*, HEC Montréal

2021

Teaching Assistant, *Derivatives Pricing (M.Sc.)*, HEC Montréal

2020

Teaching Assistant, *Market Risk Management (M.Sc.)*, McGill University

2018

Teaching Assistant, *Financial Econometrics (M.Sc.)*, *Corporate Finance (B.Com.)*, HEC Montréal

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

2021	The Bank of Canada Graduate Student Paper Award (<i>runner-up</i>). 1,000 CAD <i>By The Bank of Canada</i>
2020	SSRCH Doctoral Fellowship. 20,000 CAD <i>By Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council</i>
2020	Travel Grant . 750 USD <i>By American Finance Association</i>
2019	Pierre Arbour PhD Scholarship . 17,000 CAD <i>By Pierre Arbour Foundation</i>
2019	Hydro Québec PhD Scholarship . 20,000 CAD <i>By Hydro Québec</i>
2018	Jean-Louis Mercier PhD Scholarship . 6,000 CAD <i>By Jean-Louis Mercier</i>
2016-20	PhD Admission Scholarship. 80,000 CAD <i>By HEC Montréal</i>
2015	Graduation Excellence Award. 2,000 CAD <i>By Concordia University</i>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

JULY 2021	Society of Financial Econometrics (SoFiE) Summer School Kellogg School of business. Chicago, Illinois, USA (Virtual)
JULY 2019	Society of Financial Econometrics (SoFiE) Summer School Kellogg School of business. Chicago, Illinois, USA.
2018	Academic Writing Workshop HEC Montréal
2018	CEAR-RSI Household Finance Workshop Hotel Saint Sulpice. Montréal, Canada.

OTHER

DISCUSSION	World Finance Conference (2021), Global Finance Conference (2021).
LANGUAGES	English (Fluent), French (B2), Arabic (Fluent), Persian (Native).
SOFTSKILLS	MATLAB, SAS, R, $\text{\LaTeX}$
CERTIFICATE	CFA Level I passed, <i>June 2015</i>